

WHO I AM

Web development is my life. I've been doing it since I was a kid.

Although I started as a professional developer working on Microsoft Office, learning the intricacies of C++, engineering for the web is my first and greatest love.

I work on the entire stack from server back-ends, JavaScript frameworks, TCP/IP chat servers, single-page applications, metrics pipelines, to database ORMs—deployed in products used by *billions* of users.

My specialty is building rigorous engineering practices around chaotic, organically-evolved web technologies.

From the first version of JavaScript, the web has been intentionally forgiving of varying (even haphazard) coding practices. This openness is beautiful and welcome. But it also means that special care needs to be used when scaling these tools up for projects of immense complexity, armies of developers, and massive user bases. I have made it my particular specialty to help develop and cultivate best practices for sustainable, extreme-scale web development, helping large organizations like Facebook and Netflix implement them widely across teams and core infrastructure.

EMPLOYMENT

Anza (a Solana Labs spinoff) – Software Engineer – 2025 to 2026

I worked on a distributed Rust application that is a critical part of the network's infrastructure, which Anza created and maintains as the core software powering the Solana blockchain.

Netflix – Senior UI Engineer – 2022 to 2025

I led an effort to improve and promote shared engineering tools and practices across the company. I added new features to internal web apps that improved user workflows, reliability, and performance. I standardized my team's tech stack for multiple web apps, sped up our build tooling and CI pipeline, and added testing and linting.

Facebook – Front End Engineer – 2016 to 2022

I was a founding member of the team that rebuilt facebook.com from scratch in 2020, which we grew from a group of 2 to 50. I contributed to the prototype, was a tech lead for the Facebook Groups product rewrite, led all experimentation, and managed the gradual rollout.

I had many side projects that had broad, company-wide impact, such as applying Prettier, the automatic code formatter, to the entire Facebook codebase.

Microsoft – Senior Software Engineer – 2006 to 2016

I received numerous company accolades/awards (e.g. multiple patents, "Gold Stars", "high-potential" employee program, direct praise from Satya Nadella), was a formal mentor to peers, and was coach and recruiter for the Microsoft Foundry intern program.

Visual Studio Team Services (visualstudio.com)

Delivered features and led a performance improvement project on a single-page app powering Microsoft's Git version control system.

Azure Machine Learning

Developer on a UX team building a rich, browser-based IDE for Data Scientists.

Office division

Worked on projects spanning a wide range of languages and platforms such as building a jQuery framework replacement, Win32 development in C++, server development in C#, iOS development in Objective-C, etc.

OPEN-SOURCE PROJECTS

Bookcision – Bookmarklet to download Kindle highlights & notes, now part of Readwise

Architecture Write-up: <https://alan.norbauer.com/articles/bookcision>

handlebars-loader – webpack plug-in for handlebars template compilation – 100K downloads/week on npm

Monorepo for all my npm packages: <https://github.com/altano/npm-packages>

WRITING

My writing has been featured at the top of programming sites like 📰 Hacker News and 🦀 Lobste.rs:

[67 Weird Debugging Tricks Your Browser Doesn't Want You to Know](#) (Hacker News discussion)

[Relay-style GraphQL](#) (Lobste.rs discussion)

[Upgrade your Development Environments with Devbox](#) (Lobste.rs discussion)

More writing at <https://alan.norbauer.com>

EDUCATION

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute – B.S. in Computer Science, minor in Social Psychology, 2002-2006